

You can choose the type of backup: Normal, Copy, Differential, Incremental or Daily

Varun Dubey

So you have a sprawling MP3 collection, a whole lot of movies, and, of course, important documents and contacts, addresses and the like. Wouldn't you sleep a whole lot better at night knowing that you have a secure and safe backup of all your important, and possibly critical, data?

We give you step-by-step directions to back up your data to an external drive. In fact, you can back it up to pretty much any drive using the instructions given here!

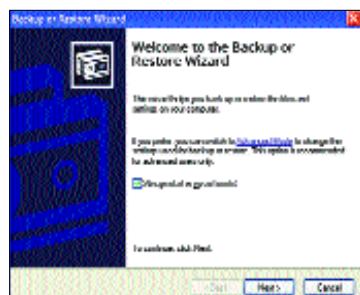
What You Need

A drive to back up your data on (any USB or FireWire external HDD). The software we will be using is Windows XP's inbuilt backup software.

STEP 1 Accessing The Software

To launch the software, go to **Start > All Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Backup**. If you don't have the software installed, you will have to add the feature from your windows XP installation CD.

The software starts with a wizard. If you just use the wizard, it is fairly simple to carry out routine backups, but we will take you through a



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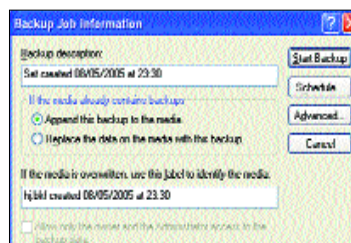
guided tour of the advanced feature set.

STEP 2 Backup

Click on the backup tab, and you will be taken to a split window akin to a file explorer. Here, you can check the boxes next to the folders on the left pane (if you want to back up the entire folder or drive). After you select folders, the entire contents (including files) are displayed. Select the files or folders you want to back up.

Once you're done, select the location to where you want to back up, and also what name you would like to specify for the backup, from the drop-down menu below. Now click 'Start Backup'. Remember, it's a good practice to keep a date and data-indicative nomenclature.

When you click 'Start



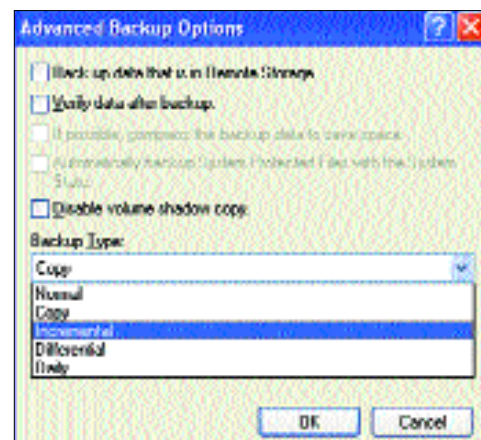
Enter the name of the backup file

Backup', you will be presented with a backup 'Job Information' window where you can modify the name and description of the backup.

Now you have two options: you can either append the backup to your existing backups on the media, or you can wipe out other backups and create a new one by selecting 'Replace the backups in the media with this backup'.

STEP 3 Advanced Options

Clicking on the 'Advanced' tab will get



Choose from the various backup types available

you to a backup options window where you can choose to verify the data after backup, or back up data onto remote storage. You can also choose the type of backup, as mentioned below.

Normal: A regular backup.

Copy: Simply backs up the selected data, but does not mark anything as backed up.

Incremental: Backs up the selected files only if they have been created or modified since the last backup.

Differential: The same as incremental, except that it does not mark the files as backed up.

Daily: Backs up the files created or modified only today.

When you click 'Schedule', you will be prompted with a warning that says you should save your backups before scheduling. Click 'Yes', and you will be prompted to set up a password for security reasons. Just enter a password and confirm it, and you will be ready.

You will be taken to a window where you can give this schedule a name, and using the options button, configure options such as 'don't backup if running on

